

KASPERSKY LAB'S TIPS ON SAFE SOCIAL NETWORKING

Social networking cybercrime

Cybercriminals use social networking sites, like Twitter, Facebook, Bebo, MySpace or LinkedIn to distribute malicious code or befriend unsuspecting users to steal their personal information. Follow the five simple steps below to keep yourself protected.

1. Post minimum personal information
2. Only post information or photos that you are happy for anyone to see
3. Be wary of strangers
4. Use strong passwords or ideally use a password manager
5. Use Internet Security Software and keep it up to date

Other social media risks

Avoid opening any links that come into your e-mail inbox from a social networking site. Even if it is a social network that you are a member of, it is far safer to directly log on to that site and check your messages from there.

Internet fraudsters typically use genuine logos, good business style

and may even spoof the header and sent-from of the e-mail to make it look legitimate. But phishing scams are the bait used to try and lure customers into clicking on the link included in the e-mail. The link takes the user directly to the specially constructed site.

By not clicking on links that may be fake, you are one step closer to protecting yourself online. This approach, applied alongside installing Internet Security, will keep you and your internet accessible devices as safe as possible.

There is always the risk that even private information that is restricted could be exposed, so it really is important that you don't post anything that you wouldn't want the public to see. Also, be cautious when deciding which applications (apps) to enable. Check your settings so you know what information the applications will be able to access – and to make sure you do not unwittingly reveal private information. ◀